No-one can time the market. Investors in training dollar cost average and keep some cash, perhaps $1000 to $2000, aside just in case they see a drop and want to add extra money into their fund. But that's their extent of 'trying to time the market'.

Time is money, and investors in training would rather spend their time enjoying their lives and having meaningful experiences than hunching over a screen daily trying to work out the next drop. After all, aren't we investing for more freedom of time?

You can dollar cost average every week, fortnight or month. If you are unsure which time frame is better, the rule of thumb is that the more money you have to invest the more often you can invest to counteract the brokerage fees you might face at each investment. Investing $10 a week with a $2 fee may not be wise, but investing $500 a week for a $2 fee suddenly isn't so bad.

Another downside of trying to time the market is that sometimes people get so much analysis paralysis they miss out on the market completely.

You don't want to be the person who keeps waiting for the best time to invest and ends up never investing at all.

#3: Emotions and the market

One of our top traits is that we have good emotional control when the markets fluctuate. (A bit ironic since we've always been told that we're an overly emotional gender and any bad mood is due to probably being 'on our periods'. I guess our investing portfolios say otherwise.)

You know those stock photos of men with their heads in their hands during stock market news? You do not want to react like those men during volatile times in the market, because you know as an investor in training that volatility is to be expected and that you're investing for the long term. Bet they feel really silly now.

When emotions take over our strategy, investors tend to elevate risks that they could otherwise avoid. This is not exactly brand-new information; we